

Ideation Phase
Empathize & Discover – Empathy Map Canvas

Date	10 July 2026
Team ID	
Project Name	Smart Lender – AI-Powered Loan Approval Prediction System
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Purpose

An empathy map is a simple, easy-to-digest visual that captures knowledge about a user's behaviours and attitudes, helping the team design a solution around the applicant's real needs.

Empathy Map Canvas

Section	What to Write
Who are we empathizing with?	Loan applicants approaching a bank or NBFC, and loan officers who review applications.
What do they need to do?	Submit accurate personal and financial details and get a quick, fair approval decision.
What do they see?	Lengthy paper forms, unclear eligibility criteria, and long waiting periods for a decision.
What do they say?	“I submitted all my documents, why is it taking so long to know if I am eligible?”
What do they do?	Follow up repeatedly with the branch, or apply at multiple banks to improve their chances.
What do they hear?	“Your application is under review,” “We will get back to you.”
What do they think and feel?	Anxious about credit history and income eligibility; frustrated by the lack of transparency.
Pain Points	Manual verification, inconsistent decisions across officers, no visibility into why an application was rejected.
Gains (Goals)	A fast, consistent, and transparent loan evaluation with a clear reason for the outcome.

Empathy Map Canvas – Visual

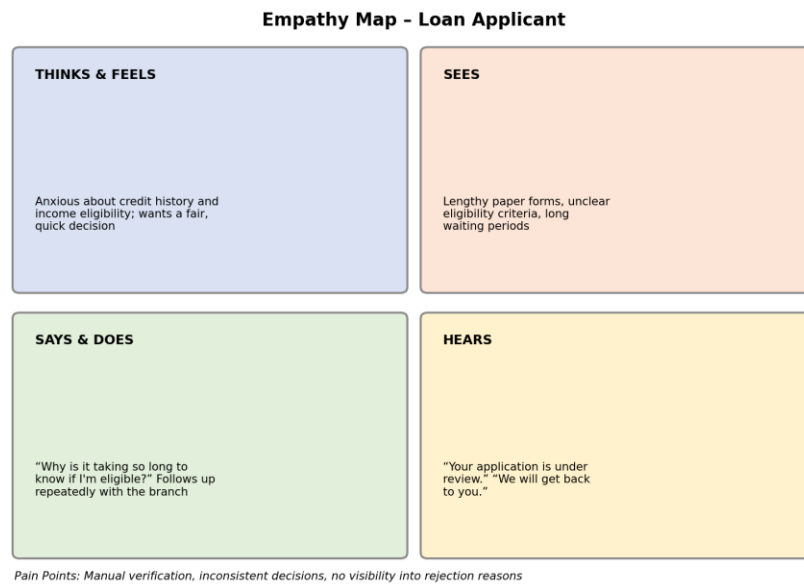


Fig 1: Empathy Map – Loan Applicant

Example: Smart Lender – AI-Powered Loan Approval Prediction System